

The Parables of Jesus: Hidden Truths Revealed

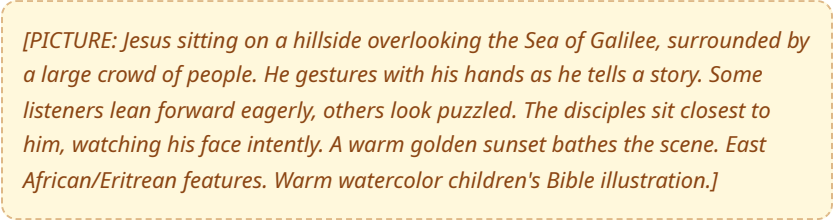
ገጽ 73 ከ 80

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Ages 10-17

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories
Book 73 of 80

Scene 1 of 25



Jesus was the greatest storyteller who ever lived — but His stories were never just entertainment. They were carefully crafted vessels carrying hidden truths about the kingdom of God. The crowds came by the thousands to hear Him speak, yet He rarely taught in plain, direct statements. Instead, He wrapped eternal truths in everyday images: seeds, soil, bread, sheep, coins, weddings, harvests. "Why do you speak to the people in parables?" His disciples asked. Jesus answered: "Because the knowledge of the secrets of the kingdom of heaven has been given to you, but not to them." Parables were simultaneously a revelation and a concealment. For those with ears to hear — those hungry for truth, those willing to wrestle with meaning — parables opened doors to understanding. For those who were merely curious or hostile, parables remained pleasant but puzzling stories. Jesus hid truth in stories not to keep people out, but to draw the truly seeking heart deeper in.

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*Yesus fets'imu zinebere zi'abeye tezarabi zanta nebere — ginake zantatatu fets'imen
nimizinga'e tiray ayneberan. Biza'iba mengisti Amlak siwrat Haqitat ziHaza biTinqaqe
ziteserHa haberetata nebera. Bi'ashiHat ziquTs'eru sebat kizareb kisim'u yimets'u
neberu ginake binits'ur qeT'ta qalat darga aymeharen. Ab kinda'u nay zeze'alem
Haqitat ab iletawi si'ilitat yiKhednen nebere: zer'i, meret, injera, abagi'e, santim,
mer'a, ats'id.*

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*Misla zera'i minalbat nay Yesus aziyu seretawi zanta iyu — kulom kal'ot mislitat
 biKemey kem nisim'e zimhirena. "Hade Harestay zer'i kizer'e wets'e" ilu Yesus yijmir.
 Zer'i kizer'e kelo ab arba'ite zitefelaleye aynet meret wedeqe. Gele ab godena wedeqe
 — meret bi'igri seb ts'inu'e zikone — a'iwaf biqits'bet mets'i'an beli'a'o. Gele ab kewHi
 bota wedeqe — meret ziHats'ere — qeliTifu beqwele ginake ts'eHay mis wets'et sur sle
 zeybilu nededen neqets'en.*

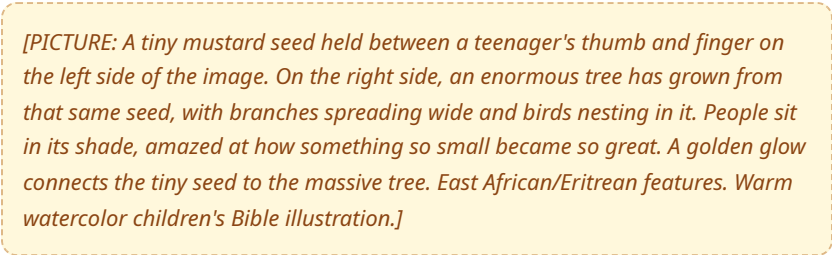
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Ayenay meret iKha? Godena ts'inu'e libi yiwkil — qal Amlak zisim'e ginake fets'imu zey'atu seb. Sur qidmi miHaz ts'ela'i yiwesdo. Minalbat nay ametat qanza, TirTare wey zinga'e libKha nimenfesawi Haqi ats'ni'u. KewHi meret simi'itawi ginake ziHats'ere milash yiwkil — ab kamp wey guba'e biza'iba Amlak tiHgos ginake ts'egem mis mets'e amiq sur sle zey'abeye imnetiKa yiTef'e.

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*Sirnayni qwelen kulu nibur ziHasib gobez zirebsho neger yigelts': Amlak niminay
 Himaq mis ts'ibuq biHansab kinebir yifeqid? "Mengisti semay ab giratu ts'ibuq zer'i
 zizer'a seb timisil" bele Yesus. "Ginake kulu seb deqisu kelo ts'ela'iu mets'iu ab ma'ikel
 sirnay qwele zer'a." Agelgelti qwele ab ma'ikel sirnay ki'abi mis re'ayu Hatetu:
 "Keydna kiningilo tideli?" Melsi goyta zigerim iyu: "Ayfal qwele kitingilu keleKhum
 misau sirnay kitibuqlu tiKh'ilu. Kiltiu kisab ats'id biHansab yi'ibe."*

Scene 5 of 25



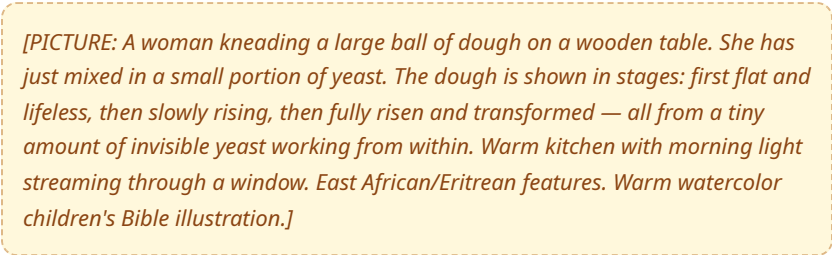
The Mustard Seed parable demolishes our obsession with size and immediate results. "The kingdom of heaven is like a mustard seed, which a man took and planted in his field. Though it is the smallest of all seeds, yet when it grows, it is the largest of garden plants and becomes a tree, so that the birds come and perch in its branches." The kingdom of God does not arrive with overwhelming force or instant spectacle. It starts impossibly small — a baby born in a manger, twelve ordinary men, a handful of believers in an upper room. But it grows. Relentlessly, unstoppably, it grows until it becomes something vast enough to shelter nations. This parable speaks to every teenager who feels their faith is too small to matter, their influence too limited to count, their contribution too insignificant to notice. God specializes in small beginnings. He plants kingdoms in mustard seeds. Your small act of faithfulness today — that prayer, that kindness, that choice to obey — is a seed that God will grow beyond anything you can imagine.

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Misla fire adri bi'aqenin biqits'betawi wits'itin zelena sis'e yiferis. "Mengisti semay Hade seb wesidu ab giratu ziteKhelo fire adri timisil. Kab kulu zer'i ni'ishto kinesa mis abeyet kab kulu teKhli ataKhilti ti'abi om tiKhewn a'iwaf semay dima ab chenaфра yiqmeTa." Mengisti Amlak biziHbiT Hayli wey biqits'betawi dimqet ayimets'in. Bizeyke'al zini'ase yijmir — ab mebl'e zitewelde hits'an, aserte kilte niburit sebat, ab la'ilewey kifli Hidet aminti.

Scene 6 of 25



The Leaven parable complements the mustard seed but adds a crucial dimension. "The kingdom of heaven is like yeast that a woman took and mixed into about sixty pounds of flour until it worked all through the dough." The mustard seed shows outward growth — the kingdom expanding visibly. The yeast shows inward transformation — the kingdom working invisibly from within to change everything it touches. Yeast is invisible. You cannot see it working. Yet it permeates every particle of dough, transforming the entire batch from the inside out. This is how God's kingdom operates in a human heart and in a culture. It rarely arrives with dramatic fanfare. Instead, it works quietly, persistently, invisibly — transforming attitudes, reshaping values, redefining priorities, changing relationships. You may not see God working in your life today. But if you have received His word, the yeast is active. It is transforming you from within, even when you cannot perceive the change. Trust the process. The kingdom works in hidden ways.

በዚህ ምሳሌ ውስጥ የእግዚአብሔር መንፍቅ በሕይወታችን ውስጥ የሚሰራውን ማሳሰቢያ ይሰጣል። "የእግዚአብሔር መንፍቅ ለሕይወታችን ውስጥ የሚሰራውን ማሳሰቢያ ይሰጣል።" በዚህ ምሳሌ ውስጥ የእግዚአብሔር መንፍቅ ለሕይወታችን ውስጥ የሚሰራውን ማሳሰቢያ ይሰጣል። — በዚህ ምሳሌ ውስጥ የእግዚአብሔር መንፍቅ ለሕይወታችን ውስጥ የሚሰራውን ማሳሰቢያ ይሰጣል። — በዚህ ምሳሌ ውስጥ የእግዚአብሔር መንፍቅ ለሕይወታችን ውስጥ የሚሰራውን ማሳሰቢያ ይሰጣል። በዚህ ምሳሌ ውስጥ የእግዚአብሔር መንፍቅ ለሕይወታችን ውስጥ የሚሰራውን ማሳሰቢያ ይሰጣል። በዚህ ምሳሌ ውስጥ የእግዚአብሔር መንፍቅ ለሕይወታችን ውስጥ የሚሰራውን ማሳሰቢያ ይሰጣል።

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*Misla may biHuq nifre adri yimila'o ginake agedasi gets' yiwisKh. "Mengisti semay
 Hanti sebeyti wesida ab seleste se'a HariCH ziHawesetato may biHuq timisil kulu
 kisab zibeku'e." Fire adri nidege ibyet yiri'i — mengisti biziri'a tigefiH. May biHuq
 niwishTawi lewTi yiri'i — mengisti bizey miri'ay kab wishTi tiserH nizatinkifo kulu tiqyir.
 May biHuq ayri'an. KiserH kelo ayiri'iyon.*

Scene 7 of 25

[PICTURE: A man digging in a field who has just struck something — a treasure chest glowing with golden light beneath the soil. His face shows absolute shock and overwhelming joy. In the next frame, he is running to sell everything he owns — his house, animals, possessions — with pure happiness, not reluctance, because he knows what awaits him. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"The kingdom of heaven is like treasure hidden in a field. When a man found it, he hid it again, and then in his joy went and sold all he had and bought that field." Notice: he sold everything **IN HIS JOY**. This was not a sacrifice that felt like loss — it was a trade that felt like gain. He was not giving up treasures for nothing; he was giving up lesser treasures for the greatest treasure. This is the kingdom's economy: everything else becomes worthless compared to what you've found. The man did not reluctantly part with his possessions while mourning what he lost. He joyfully released everything because he had found something infinitely more valuable. This is what genuine encounter with God's kingdom looks like — not gritting your teeth to give things up for God, but joyfully releasing anything that stands between you and the treasure. When you truly see the kingdom's worth, sacrifice stops feeling like sacrifice. It feels like the smartest investment you've ever made.

[illegible]

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*Mengisti semay ab girat ziteHab'a mezgeb timisil. Hade seb mis reKhebo debqo
diHri'u biHagosu keydu zelewo kulu sheytu neta girat adega. Astebhil: kulu biHagosu
sheyeTe. Izi kem kisara zisim'e miswa'iti ayneberan — kem rebHa zisim'e nigid
nebere. Nigele keyhabe habti ayhaben — nizi'abeye habti zini'ase habti habe.*

Scene 8 of 25

[PICTURE: A pearl merchant examining many beautiful pearls on a velvet cloth — rubies, emeralds, diamonds, all impressive. Then his eyes fall on ONE pearl of extraordinary size and radiance, glowing with an inner light unlike anything else. His other pearls suddenly look dim by comparison. He pushes all the others aside, reaching for the one. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"Again, the kingdom of heaven is like a merchant looking for fine pearls. When he found one of great value, he went away and sold everything he had and bought it." This parable is similar to the hidden treasure but with an important difference: the merchant was actively searching. He was a professional — he knew quality. He had spent his life accumulating fine pearls. His collection was impressive. But when he encountered this ONE pearl, everything else paled. He did not hesitate. He sold his entire collection — pearls he had spent a lifetime gathering — for this single pearl of surpassing worth. The kingdom of God is like that. It is the one thing worth more than all else combined. Not one of many good options — THE option. Not another addition to your collection of interests — the replacement of everything lesser. Jesus does not ask to be one priority among many. He asks to be THE pearl — the one thing for which you gladly release all others. What are you unwilling to let go of? What "good pearls" are you clutching that prevent you from grasping the great one?

[illegible]

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*Kem biHadish mengisti semay ts'ibua inqu zideli negaday timisil. Hanti aziya kibrit
 mis reKhebe keydu zelewo kulu sheytu adega. Izi misla mis ziteHab'a mezgeb
 yimisasel ginake agedasi fililay alewo: negaday binTifet yideli nebere. Moyawi nebere
 — biq'at yifliT nebere. Hiyowetu kula ts'ibua inqu ki'ikib aHlifu. Sibsibu zideniq
 nebere. Ginake neza Hanti inqu mis agaTemo kulu kal'e dibziz kone.*

Scene 9 of 25

[PICTURE: Two scenes side by side. Left: A king forgiving a servant who owes an enormous debt — millions of coins shown in massive piles. The servant kneels gratefully as chains fall off. Right: That same servant grabbing a fellow servant by the throat, demanding repayment of a tiny handful of coins. The contrast is stark and shocking. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

The Unforgiving Servant exposes the absurdity of receiving grace but refusing to give it. A king decided to settle accounts. One servant owed him ten thousand talents — an astronomical sum, equivalent to millions today. Unable to pay, the servant begged for mercy. Moved with compassion, the king forgave the ENTIRE debt. That servant then went out and found a fellow servant who owed him a hundred denarii — a tiny fraction of what he had been forgiven. He grabbed him by the throat and demanded payment. When the fellow servant begged for patience, the forgiven servant refused and threw him into prison. The king, hearing this, was furious: "You wicked servant! I cancelled all that debt of yours. Shouldn't you have had mercy on your fellow servant just as I had on you?" Jesus is saying: God has forgiven you an unpayable debt — the debt of your sin against a holy God. If you have received that forgiveness but refuse to forgive others their relatively small offenses against you, you reveal that you never truly understood what you received.

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*Misla zeymihir agelgali ts'ega miqbal ginake mihab mi'ibay kindey zeymiknu'y
miwKhanu yiqali'e. Hade nigus Hisab kiwid'e wesene. Hade agelgali aserte shiH talent
— zeytits'ebe abi genzeb lomi milyonat zidaareg — yi'idewo nebere. KiKhefil sle
zeykk'ale agelgali mihret lemene. Nigus biriHraHe tenqesaqisu milu'e ida Hadega. Eti
agelgali diHri'u wets'i'u mi'iti dinar — ziteHadegedu ni'ishto kifal — zi'idewo bits'ay
agelgali reKhebe.*

Scene 10 of 25

[PICTURE: A vineyard at different times of day. Workers who started at dawn stand alongside workers who just arrived in the late afternoon. The landowner pays them all the same wage — one denarius each. The early workers look outraged, pointing at those who worked only an hour. The late workers look grateful and amazed. The landowner's face shows generous kindness, not injustice. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

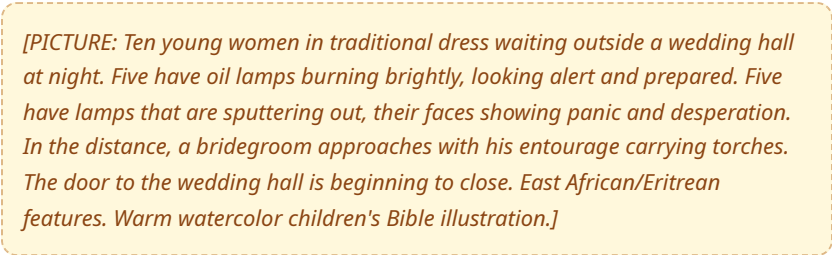
The Workers in the Vineyard is one of Jesus's most offensive parables — offensive because it attacks our deep sense of fairness. A landowner hired workers at dawn, agreeing to pay them a denarius for the day. He went out again at 9 AM, noon, 3 PM, and even 5 PM, hiring more workers each time. At the end of the day, he paid everyone the same — starting with the last hired. Those who worked all day expected more, but received the same denarius. They grumbled: "You have made them equal to us who have borne the burden of the work and the heat of the day!" The landowner replied: "I am not being unfair to you. Didn't you agree to work for a denarius? I want to give the one who was hired last the same as I gave you. Don't I have the right to do what I want with my own money? Or are you envious because I am generous?" Grace offends those who think they deserve more. The kingdom is not about earning — it's about receiving. God's generosity is not limited by our calculations of who deserves what.

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*Misla seraHtenyatat ab weyni girat kab aziyom ziqeymu mislitat Yesus Hanti iya —
 ziqeyim mikniyatu amiq nay fitHi simi'itna sle ziTiqa'e. Hade wana girat ab wegaHta
 seraHtenyatat qwets'ere nime'alti Hade dinar kiKeflom tesemamimu. Se'at 9 ngiho,
 qetri, se'at 3 diHri qetri, se'at 5 diHri qetri'kwa temelisu wets'e kulu gize tewesKhti
 seraHtenyatat qwets'ere. Ab meweda'eta me'alti kulom Hade Khefelom.*

Scene 11 of 25



The Ten Virgins parable is about readiness — and the terrifying possibility of being too late. Ten young women took their lamps and went out to meet the bridegroom. Five were wise and brought extra oil; five were foolish and brought none. The bridegroom was delayed, and they all fell asleep. At midnight, the cry rang out: "Here's the bridegroom! Come out to meet him!" The wise virgins trimmed their lamps, which burned brightly. The foolish ones found their lamps going out and begged: "Give us some of your oil!" But the wise replied: "There may not be enough for both of us. Go buy your own." While the foolish went to buy oil, the bridegroom arrived. Those who were ready went in with him to the wedding banquet, and the door was shut. When the foolish returned, they cried: "Lord, Lord, open the door for us!" But he answered: "Truly I tell you, I don't know you." This parable is about Jesus's return. Readiness cannot be borrowed at the last minute. You cannot live on someone else's faith. Your own relationship with God must be cultivated NOW — because you do not know the hour.

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 ሰጠላህ ሰጠ ሰጠላህ ሰጠ" ሰጠ ሰጠላህ ሰጠ ሰጠላህ ሰጠ ሰጠላህ ሰጠ ሰጠ
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*Misla aserte denagil biza'iba diluwnet — kem'u'win biTa'imi midingway zifrih teKh'ilo
 iyu. Aserte awalid mebrahten Hizen nimri'awi kiqbela wets'a. Hamushte Tibe benyatat
 tewesaKhi zeyti Hizen — Hamushte ayshu zeyHizen. Mri'awi sle zidengoye kulatena
 deqesa. Firqi leyti "incho mri'awi! kitqibela'o wits'a!" zibil cHidirta tesim'e. Tibe benyatat
 denagil mebrahten adalewa birhan abirha.*

Scene 12 of 25

[PICTURE: Three servants receiving bags of gold from a wealthy master who is departing on a journey. One receives five bags, one two, one one. Time passes (shown by sun moving across sky). Two servants are shown actively investing — trading, farming, building. The third digs a hole and buries his bag, looking fearful and resentful. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

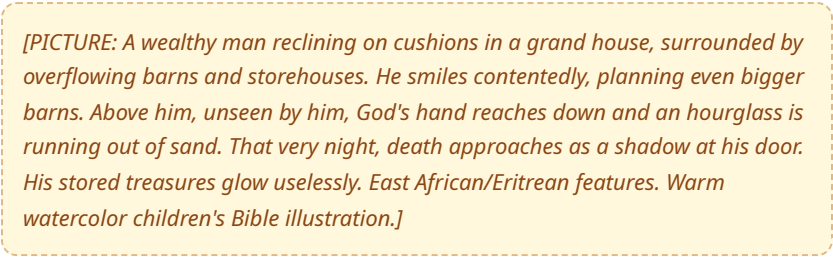
The Parable of the Talents teaches that God entrusts resources to us and expects a return. A man going on a journey gave his servants talents according to their ability: five to one, two to another, one to a third. The first two invested wisely and doubled their master's money. The third, driven by fear, buried his talent in the ground. When the master returned, he praised the first two: "Well done, good and faithful servant! You have been faithful with a few things; I will put you in charge of many things." But to the one who buried his talent, the master was harsh: "You wicked, lazy servant! You should have at least put my money on deposit so it would have earned interest." The talent was taken from him and given to the one who had ten. The principle is clear: use it or lose it. God has given you abilities, opportunities, resources, influence, and time. He does not expect you to have what He didn't give — but He absolutely expects you to use what He did give. Fear of failure is not an excuse for inaction. The only true failure is burying what God gave you.

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*Misla talentat Amlak habti hibuna mimilas kem zits'be yimhir. Nab gu'izo ziKeyd seb
 ni'agelgeltu biKHi'letom meTen talentat habe: niHade Hamushte, niKhal'e kilte,
 nialisay Hade. Qedamot kilte biTibeb weferu genzeb goytaom its'fi geberu. Salisay
 bifiRHi temeriru talentu ab meret qebere. Goyta mis temelise niqedamot kilte
 amesgene: "Ts'ibuuq amun agelgali! BiwiHud neger amun nerKa ab bizuH neger
 kemaliKteKa iye."*

Scene 13 of 25



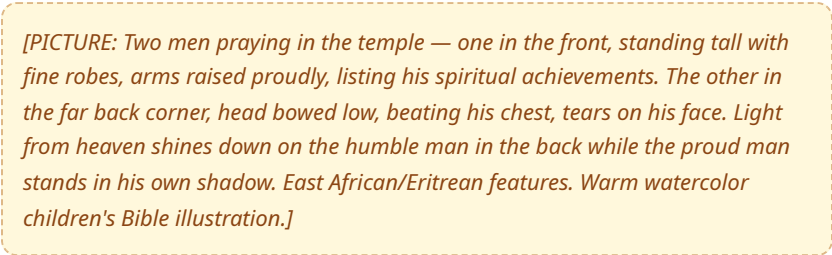
The Rich Fool parable warns against building your life around things that cannot last. A rich man's land produced abundantly. He thought to himself: "What shall I do? I have no place to store my crops." He decided: "I will tear down my barns and build bigger ones. Then I'll say to myself, 'You have plenty of grain laid up for many years. Take life easy; eat, drink and be merry.'" But God said to him: "You fool! This very night your life will be demanded from you. Then who will get what you have prepared for yourself?" Jesus concluded: "This is how it will be with whoever stores up things for themselves but is not rich toward God." Notice the man's fatal error: he talked only to himself about himself for himself. No mention of God, no thought of others, no consideration of eternity. He was not evil — he was simply self-absorbed. His wealth was not his sin; his forgetfulness of God and others was. You can be "successful" by every earthly measure and be an absolute fool in God's eyes if your life revolves entirely around storing up for yourself while being poor toward God and others.

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*Misla ilul habtam ab zeyts'enH negarrat hiyowetiKa mihinats' ziTenqiq iyu. Meret
 Hade habtam seb bibziHi afreyet. Nigeza'e ri'isu Hasebe: "Intay kigebir? Firyatey abey
 keqemiT?" Wesene: "Abeyti kofaltat kihanTs' aleni. DiHri'u nigeza'e ri'isey kibil 'nibizuH
 ametat zi'aKhil bizuH iKhli aleKa. Tezanaga'e — bila'e site teHagos." Ginake Amlak
 belo: "Ata asha! Lomi leyti hiyowetiKa kiwsed iyu. DiHri'u nigeza'e ri'isKha zidaleKhayo
 men kireKhbo?"*

Scene 14 of 25



The Pharisee and the Tax Collector shows two radically different approaches to God — and which one He accepts. "Two men went up to the temple to pray, one a Pharisee and the other a tax collector. The Pharisee stood by himself and prayed: 'God, I thank you that I am not like other people — robbers, evildoers, adulterers — or even like this tax collector. I fast twice a week and give a tenth of all I get.'" His prayer was really a self-congratulation speech with God as audience. He compared himself to others and came out looking good — in his own eyes. "But the tax collector stood at a distance. He would not even look up to heaven, but beat his breast and said: 'God, have mercy on me, a sinner.'" Jesus's verdict: "I tell you that this man, rather than the other, went home justified before God. For all those who exalt themselves will be humbled, and those who humble themselves will be exalted." God is not impressed by your spiritual resume. He responds to honest desperation, humble confession, and genuine need. The way UP in God's kingdom is always DOWN — down in humility, down in honesty, down in dependence.

ገጽ 14 ከ 25 ጋር ይዛም፡ ሁለት ሰው ወደ ቤተ መጻህፍት ሲሄዱ ለመገባወጥ ጥረው ነበረ። አንዱ የፋሪስ ነበር፣ ሌላው ደግሞ የጽዕን ሰው ነበረ። የፋሪሱ ግብዓት፡ 'እግዚአብሔር ጌጃ፣ እኔን ከሌሎች ሰውያን ምሳሌ ሳይሆን፣ ከወገኖች፣ ከፍገገኞች፣ ከጋራዊዎች፣ እና ከዚህ ጽዕን ሰው ጋር ይመሳሰላል። ሁለት ጊዜ ሳባዊ እና ከሰው ገቢዬ ስኞት ሰጥቼ ነው።' ሆኖ ግብዓቱን አደረገ። ግብዓቱን አደረገው ለእግዚአብሔር ግብዓት አደረገ። ግብዓቱን አደረገው ለእግዚአብሔር ግብዓት አደረገ።

Ferisawin teqebali qerets'in niAmlak kilte biHrise zitefelaleye aqerarban ayenay kem ziqibilin yiri'i. "Kilte sebat kits'liyu nab bete meqdes deye bu Hade Ferisawi kal'ay teqebali qerets'. Ferisawi nibeynu dew ilu ts'eleye: 'AmIKhey kem kal'ot sebat — kem sereqti, gebenenyatat, zemewti — wey kemzi teqebali qerets'kwa sle zeykonKu emesgineKa. Semunawi kilte gize ets'om zireKhebKu kulu ishir ewets'e."

[illegible]

Misla kilte hanesiti nisibket ab keren bits'inu'e meTenqeqta yi'ats'wo. "Nezen qalaley semi'u zigibren kulu betu ab kewHi zihenets'e lebam seb yimisil. Zinab werede wiHiz tel'ale nifas nefese neta bet ts'efa'a ginake aywdeqetin mikniyatuu mesereta ab kewHi sle zinebere." KewHi qal Amlak misma'e tiray aykonen — migbar iyu. "Ginake nezen qalaley semi'u zeygibren kulu betu ab Huts'a zihenets'e asha seb yimisil. Zinab werede wiHiz tel'ale nifas nefese neta bet ts'efa'a bi'abi inwet wedeqet."

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*Misla merbeb nay meweda'eta firdi Haqenyan zeyterfin miwKhanu yigelts'. "Mengisti
 semay ab baHri zitederbeye kulu aynet asa ziHaze merbeb timisil. Mis mele'a gefefti
 nab gemgem seHabu. DiHri'u kof ilom ts'ibuaq asa ab qiriChat akebu ginake Himaq
 derbeyu. Ab meweda'eta zemen kemzi kiKhewn iyu. Mela'iKhti kimets'u niKhfu'at kab
 ts'adqan kifeliyu nab zinedid iton kidirbyu iyom."*

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*Misla ts'inu'e mebelet ts'elot ts'in'at kem zedliyan zeymiqrats' zi'abiyu Amlak kem
 zishilmin yimhir. "Ab Hanti ketema niAmlak zeyferih niseb zeyHafir feradi nebere.
 Abta ketema dima Hanti mebelet neberet 'kab tets'aba'iyey fitHi gibereley' tibil
 biqets'ali timets'o neberet. Nigize Hade abeye. Ginake ab meweda'eta nigeza'e ri'isu
 'niAmlak zeyferih niseb zeyHafir ikwa bimiwKhaney ginake iza mebelet biqets'ali sle
 tirebsheni fitHi kewits'a'la aleni ab meweda'eta keytimets'ani' bele."*

Scene 19 of 25

[PICTURE: Jesus as a shepherd standing at the entrance of a sheep pen, calling his sheep by name. Each sheep has a unique marking and responds individually to his voice. Strangers try to call from the sides, but the sheep ignore them and walk only toward Jesus's voice. The relationship between shepherd and sheep is intimate and personal. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"I am the good shepherd; I know my sheep and my sheep know me." The Good Shepherd parable is deeply personal — it's about knowing and being known. In ancient Palestine, shepherds knew each sheep individually. They named them, recognized their sounds, understood their temperaments. And the sheep knew their shepherd's voice so intimately that they would follow him through a crowd of other shepherds without hesitation. Jesus says this is the relationship He wants with you: not distant, not institutional, not rule-based — but intimate, personal, voice-to-voice. He KNOWS you — your fears, your dreams, your struggles, your potential. And He invites you to know Him — not just know ABOUT Him through religion, but know His voice so well that you can distinguish it from every other voice competing for your attention. "The good shepherd lays down his life for the sheep." A hired hand runs when danger comes. But the shepherd who owns the sheep, who loves the sheep, who has invested everything in the sheep — he stays and fights, even unto death. Jesus proved this at the cross.

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 ባለቤቱ ለሰው

*Ane ts'ibua gwasas iye — abagi'ey efeliTen abagi'ey dima yifeliTani. Misla ts'ibua
 gwasas aziyu wilqawi iyu — biza'iba miflatni miflatni iyu. Ab Tintawi Filistiyem gwasot
 ninefsi wekef begi'e biwilqi yifliTu neberu. Yisemyuwen, dimts'en yilelyu, baHriyen
 yirid'u neberu. Abagi'e dima dimts'i gwasayen azyen yifliTa sle zinebera ab ma'ikel
 kal'ot gwasot bizet sikkita yis'iba nebera.*

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*Ane weyni iye niskhatKum chenapir iKhum. Abay mis tits'enHu ane dima abaKhum
 bizuH fire kitifriyu iKhum — bizey ane gele kitigebru aytiKh'ilun. Weynin chenapirin
 nay Yesus aziyu qirib nay kristiyanawi hiyowet si'ili iyu. Chenfer fire nimifray
 aydKimin — mis weyni teteHaHizu tiray yits'enH fire dima biteferTiro yiKhewn.*

Scene 21 of 25

[PICTURE: A magnificent wedding banquet hall filled with food, music, and light. A king stands at the entrance sending servants out in all directions with invitations. Some invited guests turn away — one to his field, one to his business. The servants then go to the streets, bringing in the poor, disabled, and outcasts who joyfully enter. One guest sits without wedding clothes, looking exposed. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

The Wedding Banquet parable shows that God's invitation extends to everyone — but response is required. A king prepared a wedding banquet for his son and sent servants to invite the guests. But those invited refused to come — they were too busy with farms, businesses, and daily life. The king then told his servants: "Go to the street corners and invite anyone you find." The servants gathered everyone they could find, both good and bad, and the hall was filled. But when the king entered, he noticed a man not wearing wedding clothes. "Friend, how did you get in here without wedding clothes?" The man was speechless and was thrown out. The invitation is universal — God invites everyone, regardless of status, history, or worthiness. But the invitation demands a response. You cannot enter the kingdom on your own terms, wearing your own "clothes." You must put on what the king provides — the righteousness of Christ. The tragedy is not that the invitation is limited — it is that so many refuse it, preferring their busy lives to the feast of the ages.

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በዚህ ቅጽ ላይ የተጻፈው የቅዱስ መጻሕፍት ቅጽ ነው።

ባለቤቱ ለእርሱ "እነዚህ ሰዎች ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ?" ባለቤቱ
 ባለቤቱ ለእርሱ ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ — ባለቤቱ ለእኔ ለእኔ
 ባለቤቱ ለእርሱ ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ "እነዚህ"
 ባለቤቱ ለእርሱ ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ ለእኔ — ባለቤቱ
 ባለቤቱ

Misla dirar mer'a idime Amlak nikulu kem zizrigaH ginake milash kem zedli yiri'i.
Hade nigus niwdu dirar mer'a adalwe idumat nimits'wa'e agelgelti le'aKhe. Ginake
idumat kimets'u abeyu — bigirat, binigdi, bi'iletawi hiyowet aziyom tets'emdom
neberu. Nigus ni'agelgeltu "nab godintat godena kidu ziReKhebKumo kulu ideumu"
bele.

Scene 22 of 25

[PICTURE: Jesus sitting on a throne of light, separating people into two groups like a shepherd separates sheep from goats. On his right, people who fed the hungry, clothed the naked, visited prisoners — shown in small flashback vignettes. On his left, those who walked past need without responding. The "least of these" — the poor, sick, imprisoned — stand between both groups. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

The Sheep and Goats is not technically a parable but a prophecy of final judgment — and it is stunning in what it reveals about how God measures a life. "When the Son of Man comes in his glory, he will separate the people one from another as a shepherd separates the sheep from the goats." To those on his right: "Come, you who are blessed. For I was hungry and you gave me something to eat, I was thirsty and you gave me something to drink, I was a stranger and you invited me in, I needed clothes and you clothed me, I was sick and you looked after me, I was in prison and you came to visit me." They ask in confusion: "Lord, when did we see you hungry or thirsty or a stranger or needing clothes or sick or in prison?" The King answers: "Truly I tell you, whatever you did for one of the least of these brothers and sisters of mine, you did for me." This is staggering: Jesus identifies so completely with the poor, the marginalized, and the suffering that serving them IS serving Him. How you treat "the least" — the invisible, the powerless, the forgotten — reveals your true relationship with Christ.

ባለቤቱ ወይም ልጁን ለመገናኘት ለመገናኘት ለመገናኘት ለመገናኘት — ለመገናኘት
ባለቤቱ ወይም ልጁን ለመገናኘት ለመገናኘት ለመገናኘት ለመገናኘት "ሆኖ ለመገናኘት ለመገናኘት
ባለቤቱ ወይም ልጁን ለመገናኘት ለመገናኘት ለመገናኘት ለመገናኘት" ለመገናኘት ለመገናኘት
"ሆኖ ለመገናኘት ለመገናኘት ለመገናኘት ለመገናኘት ለመገናኘት ለመገናኘት
ባለቤቱ ወይም ልጁን ለመገናኘት ለመገናኘት ለመገናኘት ለመገናኘት ለመገናኘት ለመገናኘት"

፳፻፲፱ ጸሐፊ "፳፻፲፱ ጸሐፊ ስለ ፳፻፲፱ ጸሐፊ ስለ ፳፻፲፱ ጸሐፊ ስለ ፳፻፲፱
ጸሐፊ ስለ ፳፻፲፱ ጸሐፊ?" ጸሐፊ ጸሐፊ "፳፻፲፱ ጸሐፊ ስለ ፳፻፲፱ ጸሐፊ
ጸሐፊ ጸሐፊ ጸሐፊ ጸሐፊ" ጸሐፊ ጸሐፊ ጸሐፊ ጸሐፊ ጸሐፊ
ጸሐፊ ጸሐፊ ጸሐፊ ጸሐፊ ጸሐፊ ጸሐፊ ጸሐፊ "፳፻፲፱" —
ጸሐፊ ጸሐፊ ጸሐፊ ጸሐፊ — ጸሐፊ ስለ ጸሐፊ ስለ ጸሐፊ ጸሐፊ
ጸሐፊ ጸሐፊ

*Abagi'en atalin biTeknika misla zeykone tinbit nay meweda'eta firdi iyu — Amlak
hiyowet biKemey kem zi'iqin ab zigelts' zisdemim iyu. "Wedi seb biKhibru mis mets'e
gwasu abagi'e kab atal kem zifeli nisebat kab HadiHdom kifelyom iyu." Ab yemanu
nizelewin: "Ni'u zitebarekKhum. Temiyu ablieKhumni, ts'emiE astiKhumni, gasha
koyne teqebilKumni, kidan deliyi aKhdinKumni, Hamime HabiHabKumni, ab bet
ma'iserti koyne bets'iHKumni."*

ሰላም ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ
 ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ? ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ
 ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ? ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ
 ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ
 ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ? ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ
 ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ

*Misliat lomi niminay agedesiti iyom? Mikniyatu bahriy seb ayteqeyeren. Gena qal
 Amlak ziqawem ts'inu'e libi alena. Gena ke'igib zeykh'il habti nis'ib alena. Gena ab
 Huts'a nihanTs' hiyowet sle ziferese nigirem. Gena nigeza'e ri'isna mis kal'ot
 newadadir li'ul wey tiHut nisim'e. Gena mis yiqireta, mis ts'in'at ts'elot, mis waga
 misi'ab Yesus niqales alena. Misliat nay Tinti zikhri aykonu'n — mestewat iyom.*

Scene 24 of 25

[PICTURE: A teenager reading a Bible with a magnifying glass, looking deeper into a parable. The magnifying glass reveals layers within the story — like looking through translucent pages that go deeper and deeper. Each layer shows a different application: personal, relational, societal, eternal. The teen's expression shows growing understanding and excitement. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

How to read parables — finding yourself in the story. Here are keys to unlocking Jesus's parables: First, identify the main point. Parables usually teach ONE central truth, not multiple lessons from every detail. Don't over-allegorize — find the core message. Second, consider the original audience. Who was Jesus talking to? Pharisees? Disciples? Crowds? This shapes the meaning. Third, look for the surprise. Parables almost always contain a shocking twist that overturns expectations — the despised Samaritan is the hero, the late workers get paid the same, the father runs to the rebel son. The surprise IS the point. Fourth, find yourself in the story. Which character are you? The honest answer might be uncomfortable — maybe you are the Pharisee, not the tax collector. Maybe you are the older brother, not the prodigal. Fifth, ask: what must I DO? Parables demand response, not just understanding. They are not puzzles to solve but invitations to act. Finally, let the parable read YOU. Don't try to master it — let it master you. Sit with it. Let it disturb you. Let it change you.

ቅዱስ ስፍራ ስፍራ — ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ
ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ
ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ
ስፍራ — ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ
ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ? ስፍራ? ስፍራ? ስፍራ? ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ

ባለቤቱ ለሰው ለሰው ለሰው ለሰው ለሰው ለሰው ለሰው ለሰው ለሰው —
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 ለሰው ለሰው ለሰው ለሰው ለሰው ለሰው ለሰው ለሰው ለሰው ለሰው
 — ባለቤቱ ለሰው

*Misliṭat biKeremey kitinbib — ab zanta geza'e ri'isKha mirikab. Misliṭat Yesus nimiftat
 abzi quliftat alewu: qedamay qendi neTbi leli. Misliṭat limud Hade ma'ikellay Haqi
 yimhiru kab neṣsi wekef zirizr bizuH timhirti zeykone. BiTa'imi aytemsilu — ma'ikellay
 meliKhti riKheb. Kal'ay nay mejemerta sema'iti Hiseb. Yesus nimen yizareb nebere?
 Ferisawiyān? Deqe mezamuritu? Hizbi?*

፳፻፲፱ ሰዓት ሰዓት ፳፻፲፱ ፳፻፲፱ ፳፻፲፱ ፳፻፲፱ ፳፻፲፱ ፳፻፲፱ ፳፻፲፱ ፳፻፲፱ ፳፻፲፱
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፳፻፲፱ ፳፻፲፱ ፳፻፲፱ ፳፻፲፱

*Hiji ayenay misla nihiyowetiKa aziyu yizareb? Izi nay meweda'etan aziyu agedasin
HiTo iyu. Yesus nezen zantatat nimizinga'e zeykone nimiqyar negiruwen. Nefsi wekef
misla idime iyu — bizitefelye kitiri'i, bizitefelye kitimeritTs', bizitefelye kitinebir.
Minalbat ts'inu'e meret iKha qalu kiserts' libKha kisebrelKa niAmlak kitHatit tideli.
Minalbat nay Hade talent agelgali iKha Amlak zihabeKa bifiRHi tiqebro bi'imnet
kitisigum tideli.*

ጳጳስ ጳጳስ - ጳጳስ **13:34:** "ጳጳስ ጳጳ ጳጳ ጳጳጳ ጳጳጳ ጳጳጳጳ —
ጳጳጳ ጳጳጳ ጳጳ ጳጳጳጳጳጳጳጳ"

Discussion Questions

1. Why do you think Jesus chose to teach in stories rather than giving direct lectures or commands? What is it about a parable that reaches the heart in ways that plain statements cannot? How does this change the way you approach Scripture?

[illegible]

2. Which of Jesus's parables challenges you the most personally right now, and why? Is there one that makes you uncomfortable because you see yourself in the "wrong" character? What would it look like to respond honestly to that parable this week?

[illegible]

3. The parables of the Hidden Treasure and Pearl of Great Price both involve giving up everything for the kingdom. What does it cost you to follow Jesus? Is there something you are holding onto that prevents you from fully grasping the "pearl"? What would joyful surrender look like in your life?

[illegible]

A Prayer for Ears to Hear

Lord Jesus, You are the Master Storyteller — the One who hid eternal truths in everyday images so that seeking hearts could find them. We come to You today asking for ears to hear what Your Spirit is saying through these parables. Open our understanding. Remove the hardness from our hearts that keeps Your word from penetrating. Pull up the thorns — the worries, the distractions, the competing desires — that choke the growth of Your truth in us.

Give us the courage to see ourselves honestly in Your stories. Show us where we are the unforgiving servant, clutching grudges while drowning in Your grace. Show us where we are the foolish builder, hearing without doing. Show us where we are burying our talents in fear instead of stepping out in faith. And when we see ourselves clearly, give us the courage to respond — not just to admire Your teaching but to be transformed by it.

Help us to value Your kingdom like the treasure in the field — to joyfully release anything that stands between us and You. Help us to persist in prayer like the widow — never giving up, never losing hope. Help us to abide in You like branches in the vine — not striving in our own strength but drawing life from Your presence.

Lord, make us good soil — soft, deep, receptive, fruitful. May Your word take root in us and produce a harvest beyond what we can imagine. May we hear Your voice like sheep who know their shepherd — following You through every confusion and competing call. And may we treat the least and the lost as though they were You — because they are.

We want to be ready when You return, like the wise virgins with oil in our lamps. We want to hear "well done" like the faithful servants who

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories

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